

SKIN MOMENT

do stretch marks ever go away?

What really changes, what you can do, and why it
is worth starting

THE FOUNDATION OF TRUE CARE

The question I hear most

For ten years, the first thing women asked me, often before they had even sat down, was: "Will they go away?"

Here is the answer I gave. A stretch mark will not vanish as if it had never been there. But it can fade, flatten and soften to the point where you stop looking for it in the mirror. I have seen that happen on every skin tone, on marks three months old and on marks twenty years old. It takes the right care and some patience, and it is entirely possible.

So the useful question is not "will they disappear" but "how much can they improve, and where do I start?" That is what this guide is about.

What a stretch mark is

A stretch mark is a small tear in the dermis, the deeper layer of the skin, where collagen and elastin were pulled faster than they could adapt. The surface heals over the tear, and what you see is that healed surface: a color, a shine and a texture that differ from the skin around it.

Stretch marks most often appear when the body changes faster than the skin can keep up: during pregnancy, in a teenage growth spurt, with rapid weight gain or loss, or when muscle builds quickly. Two other factors have nothing to do with stretching. One is genetics: if your parents have stretch marks, you are more likely to have them. The other is long-term use of strong steroid creams, which can cause stretch marks on their own.

This matters for one practical reason. Skin keeps renewing itself for the rest of your life, and how that healed surface looks in the years ahead depends a great deal on what happens to it from here: on the care it gets at home and on the work a professional does in the dermis. Both matter, and they work best together.

What gets better

Color. New marks are red, pink or purple because the skin around the tear is still healing. Over months, sometimes longer, that color usually settles. On lighter skin the mark turns pale, often silvery or white. On deeper skin tones, new marks are usually darker than the surrounding skin, sometimes with a hint of red; over time they may stay that color or become lighter than the skin around them. Treatment helps color as well, whether in the studio or at home. New marks even out sooner than they would on their own; old marks, whose color stopped changing years ago, can still be softened.

Texture, and this is where care matters most. Along with color, texture is what makes a mark noticeable: a surface that is uneven or shiny, sunken below the skin or raised above it. Color in some cases improves on its own. Texture does not: if you want the texture of your stretch marks to change, you have to act. You can do that at home with the right

ingredients and techniques, in the studio, or both at once. Once the texture improves, the marks become less noticeable. That is the change most of my clients wanted, and it is a realistic one.

New marks and old marks both have a path

	New marks	Older marks
How they look	red, pink, purple; on deeper tones, darker than the skin around them	pale, silvery, white; on deeper tones, darker or lighter than the skin around them
What is happening	the skin is still remodeling	the skin has settled

For both, what helps is the same: treatment at home, sun protection, and professional work in the dermis done as a course. There is a common belief that stretch marks can only be treated while they are fresh. That is not true. If your marks are old, you have not missed your chance. You just need to know that it does not happen overnight: it may take time and consistent treatment.

Why yours look different from your sister's

I once watched two sisters go through pregnancy in the same year. One came out with barely a line, the other with marks from hip to ribs. Same family, same age, same stretching.

The difference was not what they put on their skin. It was how fast the stretching happened, how much cortisol the body was producing at the time, and how elastic that particular skin was at that particular moment. Most of it is genetics and timing. If you have marks, it is not because you did something wrong or skipped a cream. Your genetics, and what you do from here to improve how your stretch marks look, will decide how much they can change.

What works, so you stop wasting money

Start with what helps. On new marks, active ingredients that support collagen and elastin while the skin is still remodeling, used every day over a period of time, make the marks less noticeable. Mineral sunscreen is a must on fresh marks. You can also combine home care with professional treatments. How much your stretch marks will improve depends on your genetics, the type of marks you have, the treatment you choose, and the experience of the person doing the work. One more thing I told every client: pain is not proof that a treatment is working better. More aggressive does not automatically mean more effective. Judge a treatment by the change it produces, not by how much you felt during the appointment.

Now what to skip, because it costs money and hope. Almond oil, cocoa butter, olive oil and vitamin E have all been studied for fading and preventing stretch marks, and in those studies the marks did not fade. A cream that promises to erase marks in two weeks is promising something skin does not do. No amount of extra water changes a mark. And do not tan to hide them: the surrounding skin may darken while the stretch marks do not, and the contrast only gets stronger. If you want temporary camouflage, self-tanner usually makes more sense.

The pattern is simple: consistency matters more than intensity, and what reaches the dermis matters more than what stays on the surface.

If you have a deeper skin tone: yes, this is for you too

You may have been told that stretch marks on your skin are harder to treat, or that nothing can be done. That is not true. What you need is a provider who understands your skin type and, above all, already works with it and knows how to handle it. With that, marks on deeper skin tones improve just as well. Before you say yes to anyone, ask two questions: how many clients with my skin tone have you worked with, and what do you do differently for us? The right answer exists, and you are allowed to keep looking until you hear it.

Your first month

So if you have a deeper skin tone and marks you want to work on, here is where to start. Choose one hydrating product with active ingredients that stimulate collagen and elastin production or help rebuild the skin, and use it on the marks every day. Put mineral sunscreen on any marks that see the sun. Take one photo of the area in the same light, then another four weeks later; skin changes too slowly to see day to day, and the photo is what shows you it is working. If you want the texture to change as well as the color, look for a provider who can answer the two questions above, so that home care and professional work start together.

Then keep going. The women who got the results they wanted were not the ones with the most expensive products. They were the ones who were regular and consistent. And if you can combine home care with professional work in the studio, the results will be better still.

This guide is educational and reflects practitioner experience. It is not medical advice and does not replace guidance from your doctor or a licensed professional. Individual results vary.